

NFPA 1850 GEAR INVENTORY

& Compliance Checklist

A practical worksheet for fire departments to track PPE ensemble elements, inspection schedules, advanced cleaning cycles, and 10-year retirement dates in line with NFPA 1850 (Selection, Care, and Maintenance of Protective Ensembles and SCBA).

DEPARTMENT & FIREFIGHTER INFORMATION

Department:	
Station:	
Firefighter Name:	
Employee ID:	
Date Completed:	
Completed By:	

1. PPE ENSEMBLE ELEMENT INVENTORY

Record every protective ensemble element assigned to this firefighter. NFPA 1850 sets a maximum 10-year service life from the date of manufacture for structural turnout gear and ensemble elements.

Ensemble Element	Mfr / Model	Size	Serial No.	Mfg. Date	In-Service Date	Last Adv. Clean	Last Adv. Inspect.	Condition	10-Yr Retire By
Helmet									
Hood									
Coat (Shell/Liner)									
Pants (Shell/Liner)									
Gloves									
Boots									
SCBA Facepiece									
SCBA Cylinder									
SCBA Harness/Regulator									
PASS Device									

Condition key: G = Good F = Fair (monitor) P = Poor (repair/replace)

2. ROUTINE INSPECTION (After Every Use / Monthly)

Perform a routine inspection after each use and at least monthly, even if unused. Check off each item once verified.

- ☐ No visible damage, rips, tears, or cuts to outer shell, liner, or moisture barrier
- ☐ Reflective trim is intact, securely attached, and reflective (not dull or peeling)
- ☐ All hardware (zippers, snaps, hooks, D-rings) functions smoothly and is not corroded
- ☐ No char, melting, burns, or heat damage to any layer
- ☐ Seams and stitching are intact with no separation or broken threads
- ☐ Hood is free of holes, shrinkage, and contamination; face opening sized correctly
- ☐ Gloves show no holes, seam separation, or stiffness affecting dexterity
- ☐ Boots: soles, steel/composite toe, and waterproofing intact; no cracking
- ☐ SCBA facepiece lens is clear, undamaged, and seal/straps are intact
- ☐ SCBA cylinder pressure is at or above operational minimum and within hydro date
- ☐ PASS device activates, alarms correctly, and battery is within service life
- ☐ No lingering odors, visible soiling, or contamination present
- ☐ All labels (size, manufacture date, certification) are legible

3. ADVANCED CLEANING & INSPECTION (At Least Annually)

NFPA 1850 requires advanced cleaning and a documented advanced inspection at least once every 12 months, performed by a trained PPE technician or verified third-party provider.

- ☐ Advanced (machine or hand) cleaning completed using approved detergent and verified water quality
- ☐ Advanced inspection completed by a certified/trained PPE technician
- ☐ Moisture barrier integrity verified (light test or equivalent method)
- ☐ Thermal liner inspected for damage, shrinkage, or loss of loft
- ☐ Trim reflectivity tested and meets minimum retroreflectivity requirements
- ☐ Garment dried and decontaminated per manufacturer instructions
- ☐ SCBA flow-tested and regulator function verified per manufacturer schedule
- ☐ Repairs (if needed) completed by an ISP-verified or manufacturer-authorized facility
- ☐ Inspection results, date, and technician name logged in gear records
- ☐ Gear with damage beyond repair flagged for retirement and removed from service

4. DEPARTMENT PROGRAM COMPLIANCE

Department-level checks to confirm an active NFPA 1850 PPE program is in place.

- ☐ A designated PPE Program Coordinator (PPC Manager) has been appointed

- ☐ Written SOPs cover selection, care, cleaning, inspection, repair, and retirement
- ☐ Individual records are maintained for every ensemble element, including loaner/rental gear
- ☐ Routine inspections are documented after each use or monthly, whichever is sooner
- ☐ Advanced cleaning and inspection are scheduled and tracked at least annually
- ☐ Retirement dates (10 years from manufacture) are tracked for every element
- ☐ Gear assigned to each firefighter is logged and updated when equipment changes
- ☐ Contaminated or damaged gear is quarantined and not returned to service until cleared
- ☐ SCBA cylinders are tracked for hydrostatic test dates and service intervals
- ☐ Budget plan accounts for scheduled replacements as elements approach retirement

Need an easier way to track all of this? GearScanner automates PPE inventory with AI label scanning, automatic 10-year retirement alerts, and cloud-synced records for your whole department. Learn more at gearsscanner.net.

This checklist is provided as a general reference based on NFPA 1850 (Standard on Selection, Care, and Maintenance of Protective Ensembles for Structural and Proximity Firefighting and Open-Circuit SCBA). It does not replace the full standard, manufacturer instructions, or your department's official SOPs. Always consult the current edition of NFPA 1850 and your equipment manufacturers for complete requirements.